

Frequently Asked Questions — Logistics & Warehousing Support

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Shipment Tracking

Q: How long does standard shipping take? A: Standard ground shipments typically arrive within 3–5 business days of dispatch. Expedited orders arrive within 2 business days, and Next-Day Air within 1 business day where available.

Q: My tracking hasn't updated in 3 days — is my order lost? A: Not yet. A shipment is only classified as “lost in transit” after 5 consecutive business days with no scan update for Standard shipping, or 2 consecutive business days for Expedited/Next-Day. If you're within that window, the shipment is likely still moving between scan points. If you exceed it, a replacement is automatically processed.

Q: Why was my order delayed? A: Delays are tagged as either carrier-caused (weather, mechanical issues) or warehouse-caused (processing/picking delays). You can request the delay reason code from support, which will indicate which category applies.

Returns & Refunds

Q: How do I return an item? A: Request an RMA number through support. The RMA is valid for 14 days — ship the item back within that window. Once it passes quality inspection at the warehouse, your refund or replacement is processed within 3 business days.

Q: Will I be charged a restocking fee? A: Only on opened, non-defective bulk/wholesale returns above 50 units, at 10%. Defective, mis-shipped, or damaged-in-transit items are never charged a restocking fee.

Q: My item arrived damaged, what do I do? A: File a damage claim within 48 hours of delivery with photos of the packaging and the item. Claims filed after 48 hours can still be reviewed but aren't guaranteed automatic approval.

Inventory & Availability

Q: How is inventory prioritized in the warehouse? A: SKUs are classified by velocity using ABC analysis. Category A (fast-moving) items sit closest to the pick face for faster fulfillment; Category C (slow-moving) items are stored in bulk racking further away.

Q: Why does the system show an item as available but my order was backordered? A: This typically happens when a cycle count variance hasn't yet been reconciled in the system, or when inventory was reserved for another order between the time you viewed availability and placed the order.

Warehouse Operations

Q: What happens to cold-chain goods that arrive out of temperature range? A: They are rejected on arrival and logged under discrepancy code DISC-04. They do not enter general inventory.

Q: How often is inventory physically counted? A: On a rotating cycle count schedule — weekly for fast-moving (Category A) SKUs, monthly for medium-velocity (Category B), and quarterly for slow-moving (Category C) SKUs.

Escalation

Q: When will I be connected to a human agent instead of the assistant? A: Automatically when: you ask for a human directly, the issue involves a financial dispute above policy threshold, the same issue has recurred more than twice unresolved, it involves a safety/injury/hazmat concern, or the requested action (like approving a large refund) requires authorization the assistant doesn't have.

Q: Can the assistant approve a refund or cancel a contract for me? A: No — those are write-type actions that require human authorization. The assistant can look up status, explain policy, and prepare the request, but final approval is escalated to the relevant team.